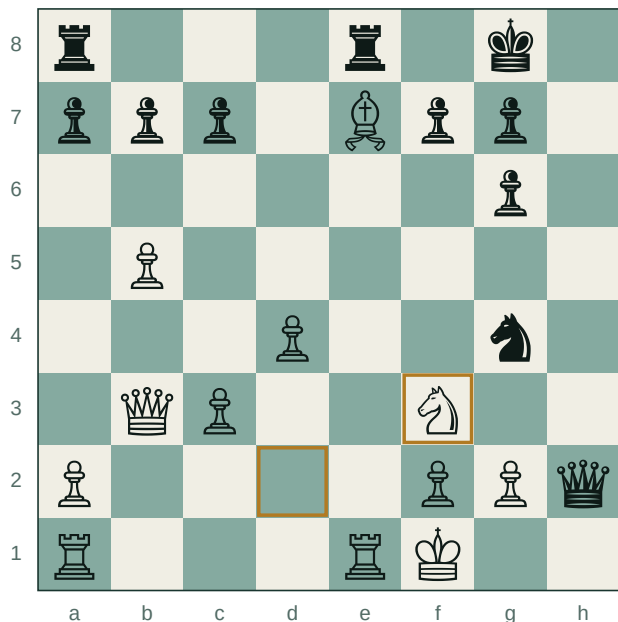


# Interference tactics: Black, move 23

Interference tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 23.Nf3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**23...Qh1+ 24. Ng1 Nh2+ 25. Ke2 Rxe7+**

**23...Qh1+** Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **24.Ng1**.

**24...Nh2+** Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **25.Ke2**.

**25...Rxe7+** Check restricts White to 4 legal replies here. The move also takes the bishop on e7.

At the end, nominal material is White 28 / Black 28 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -3 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on f1. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.